



PLANNING AUDIENCE-CENTERED BUSINESS MESSAGES

HS-304/208

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CREATING AN AUDIENCE CENTERED TONE

- Tone contributes to your message's effectiveness by supporting 3 specific goals.
- Help your audience to:
 1. Understand that your bad news represents a firm decision.
 2. Understand that under the circumstances, your decision was fair and reasonable.
 3. Remain well disposed towards your ego and preserving your audience's ego.

WRITING NEGATIVE/BAD NEWS MESSAGES

- While saying 'NO', Remember:
 - Toughest word to hear or understand
 - Terse, abrupt and rude
 - People have trouble saying it
 - Nobody likes bad news and breaking bad news is really tough
 - Care to be expected when breaking bad news
 - Remember, the most dangerous 'NO' is that you do not explain
 - The delivery can be far more dangerous than the answer to 'NO' itself.
 - Its not what you say but how you say it that counts

USING BUFFERS IN BAD NEWS MESSAGES

- Buffers are used to de-intensify bad news messages.

Types of Buffers:

1. **Agreement:** find a point on which you and the reader share similar views.
2. **Appreciation:** express sincere thanks for receiving something.
3. **Co-operation:** convey your willingness to help in any way you realistically can.
4. **Fairness:** Assure the reader that you have closely examined and carefully considered the problem, or mention an appropriate action that has already been taken.
5. **Good News:** Start with the part of a message that is favourable.
6. **Praise:** find an attribute or an achievement to contribute.
7. **Understanding:** Demonstrate that you understand the reader's goals and needs.

CHECKLIST FOR BAD NEWS MESSAGES

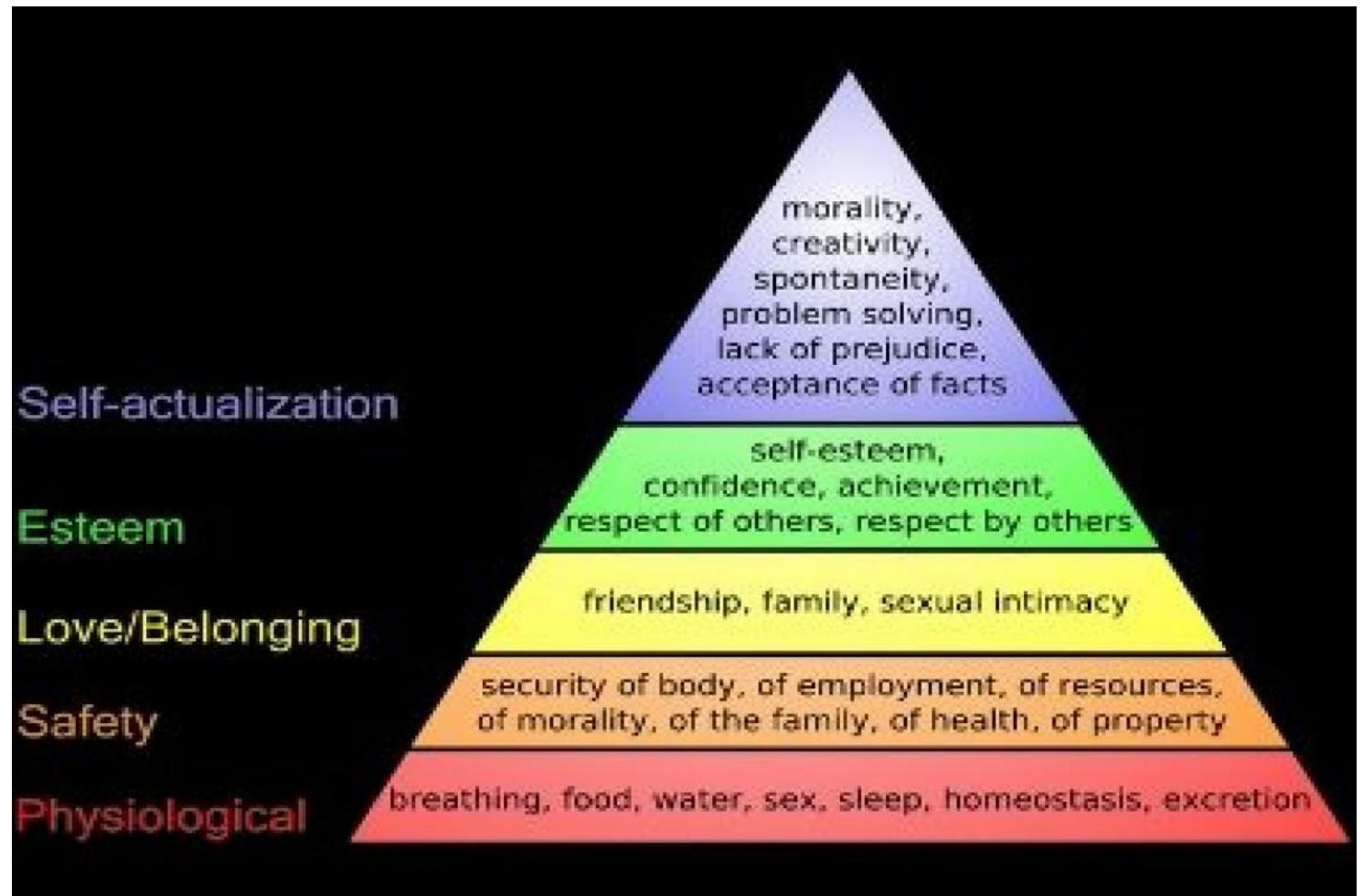
1. Buffer (pleasant or neutral statement, reader –oriented)
2. Explanation
 - Necessary data, tactfully stated
 - Pertinent favorable than unfavorable facts
 - Reader benefit reasons
3. Decision along with offer of additional help or suggestions
4. Positive, friendly close
5. Appreciation
6. Invitation to future action desired
7. Easy action, dated when desirable
8. Willingness to help further
9. Reader benefit and goodwill

PERSUASIVE MESSAGES

- Persuasive strategies:

- I. Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Marketers have found that Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs is the foundation for creating persuasive marketing content that motivates consumer purchase decisions.



HOW CAN IT BE USED IN MARKETING?



The 5-stage pyramid **can be used in marketing** to determine which need your product or service is providing, and how to effectively appeal to those motivational drivers.



PHYSIOLOGICAL NEEDS

Watch later

Does your product or service fulfil basic human needs?
THESE INCLUDE THINGS WE NEED TO LIVE, SUCH AS:

FOOD & WATER



SLEEP



SHELTER





SAFETY NEEDS

Watch later

Does your product or service fulfil needs involving security and protection?

THESE INCLUDE:

HEALTH



EMPLOYMENT



FINANCES





SOCIAL NEEDS

Watch later

Does your product or service fulfil social needs involving love, relationships, and belonging?

THESE INCLUDE THINGS LIKE:

FAMILY



FRIENDS



PETS





ESTEEM NEEDS

Watch later

Does your product or service fulfil needs involving esteem for oneself or respect and recognition from others?

AREAS INCLUDE:

PRESTIGE



ACHIEVEMENT



SELF-ESTEEM





SELF-ACTUALISATION

Watch later

This is reaching personal potential, and becoming fulfilled through growth, ambitions & experiences

GOALS



DREAMS



ASPIRATIONS



MASLOW & MARKETING

Determining where your offering fits into the pyramid means you can tailor your marketing to suit a particular demographic.

You connect best with customers when you understand their needs and wants.



RE VIDEOS

<https://www.professionalacademy.com/blogs/marketing-theories-maslows-hierarchy-of-needs/>

PERSUASIVE MESSAGES

2. Aristotle's Rhetoric: 3 types of Proofs to persuade your audience

2300 years ago the Greek philosopher, Aristotle, identified three approaches which should move the audience.

- a. Logos-logical proofs
- b. Pathos-emotional and motivational proofs
- c. Ethos-credibility proofs

Cases from Pakistan

- Every Fishermen child in the villages on the banks of Arabian Sea will be provided computers.
- Since 30-40% people in Pakistan live below the poverty line, hence investment in the name of Bagh e Ibn e Qasim at Kothari parade and the fountains of Karachi coast is completely superfluous.
- Imran Khan, the former captain of Pakistan and the captain of the World Cup squad was asked to comment on the status of cricket in Pakistan and he stressed the need for promoting district level cricket which will produce quality cricket. s

PERSUASIVE MESSAGES

■ **Logical Proofs:**

The Economic survey of Pakistan 2005 indicates ... (Recency)

The world bank and IMF jointly issued a report that says ... (Corroboration)

Micheal H. Harte in his book... (Fairnesss)

■ **Emotional Proofs:**

For reward in hereafter...

Your duty towards your country expects you...

...enables you to earn popularity in the club and entitles you to...

PERSUASIVE MESSAGES

■ Credibility Proofs

Competence: the knowledge and expertise a speaker is seen to possess

Character: the speaker's perceived morality

Task: Identify different types of proofs to persuade audiences to do the following:

1. Persue career in engineering
2. To participate in a walk for a cause
3. To buy products at a departmental store
4. To allow a university student to visit a department within a company/industry to witness a process or compile a report or collect data.
5. To use original softwares and not pirated ones.

BUILDING GOODWILL MESSAGES

- When composing effective goodwill messages, ask yourself:
 1. Who is (Are) audience (s) ? What characteristics are relevant to this particular message? If you are writing to more than one readers, how do the readers differ?
 2. What are purposes in writing?
 3. What information must your messages include?
 4. How can you build support for your position? What reasons will benefit your reader?
 5. What objection can you expect your readers to have? What negative elements of the message you must deemphasize or overcome?
 6. What aspects of the total situation may affect reader's response?

10 WAYS TO MAKE YOUR WRITING EASIER TO READ

- As you choose words:
 - Choose words that are accurate, appropriate and familiar.
 - Use technical jargons only when it is essential and known to the reader. Eliminate business jargon.
 - Use active verbs most of the time.
 - Use verbs- not nouns to carry the weight of your sentence.
 - Tighten your writing.
 - As you write and revise sentences: vary sentence length and sentence structure.
 - Use parallel structure. Use the same grammatical forms for ideas that have the same logical function.
 - Put your readers in your sentences.
 - Begin most paragraphs with topic sentences as the readers know what to expect from the paragraph.
 - Use transitions to link ideas.

CRITERIA FOR EFFECTIVE MESSAGES

- Good business or administrative writing meets five basic criteria:
 - **Its clear:** the meanings the reader gets is the meanings the writer intended. The reader does not have to guess.
 - **Its complete:** All of the reader's questions are answered. The reader has enough information to evaluate the message and act on it.
 - **Its correct:** the information is accurate, free of errors, punctuation, spellings, word order and sentence structure.
 - **It saves reader's time:** the style, organization and the visual impact of the message help the reader to read, understand and act on the message as quickly as possible.
 - **It builds goodwill:** the message presents the positive image of the writer and the organization. It treats reader as a person and cements a good relationship.